



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 47: Oral Presentation

Part 1

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Oral Presentation

- ☐ Oral communication is an extremely effective method of exchanging information.
- ☐ It introduces new vistas of knowledge.
- ☐ Every individual requires the skill of presentation in every walk of their life.
- ☐ Oral Presentations determine reputations and future successes.



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How are Oral Presentations different from other forms of Public Speaking ?

- ❖ Informative and persuasive
- ❖ Demand based
- ❖ To be given at intervals
- ❖ Based on facts

Contd...

- ❖ Time-oriented
- ❖ Use of audio visuals
- ❖ Specialized audience
- ❖ Followed by Q & A

Preparation Stages



Planning for Presentations

□ Aim of the Presentation

□ Subject of the talk

- Presentation is not speech
- Prepare more material than required
- It should arouse interest for further exploration

Heavy Water Reactors
Metal Detectors
Internet of Things
Fake News
Air Traffic Control
NEP
Professional Presentations
Smart Cities
World Peace

Pre-Presentation Preparation

Any oral presentation lasts for not more than a dedicated time slot. However, the preparations of the same do not have any time constraint.

☐ Audience Awareness

- Active audience participation is a must.
- Analyze the common background of the audience beforehand.

Type of Audiences



(Mohan and Banerji 55)

Continued...

- **Inverted Reticent**
 - Such people are reluctant to speak during interactive sessions so the best way to tackle them is to engage directly with them.
- **Intelligent Aggressor**
 - Such people have ego issues and aim to redirect the attention on themselves. One can right away seek their assistance, and appreciate the contribution of such people in order to smooth things with them.
- **Submissive Recipient**
 - Such people readily accept everything. In order to make them active participants, one can ask opinion-based questions, stimulate independent thinking, etc.

Continued...

- **Gloomy Pessimist**
 - This section of the audience owns a negative attitude. Ignoring them is not a key to a successful presentation. Instead, involve the person in the communicative process- eye contact, ask fact-based questions with conclusive answers, and so on and so forth.
- **Eager Co-operator**
 - They are open-minded and eager in a positive manner. They cooperate and respond effectively. One should be equally cooperative with such listeners.

Contd...

- ❑ Deciding the Topic
 - Make an inventory
 - Use reference books and organize the material data

- ❑ Guidance in Gathering Materials
 - Begin at Home
 - Use newspapers, the Internet sources

Contd...

❑ Selection of Material

- Mix familiar with strange
- Mix humour with serious points
- Use repetitions, examples and anecdotes

❑ Pattern

- Simple, logical and clear

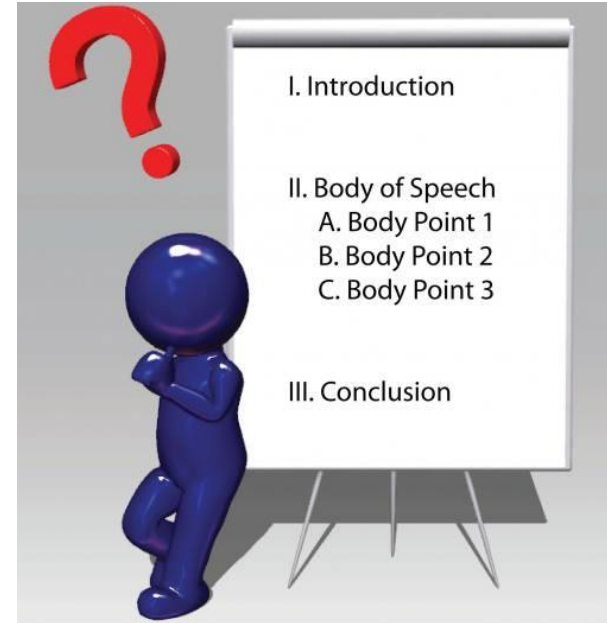
❑ Reasoning

“ There must be communication dialectic between probability and improbability. A high rate of improbability runs the risk of not being received, and therefore the message must be tempered in small degree with conventionalities, commonplaces, and must be reiterated...”

- Umberto Eco

Developing Presentation

- Only the main points should be written for proper cues while delivering.
- In order to anchor the interests of the audience, the content should be curated in a proper structure including the introduction, body and conclusion.



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Organizing Your Presentation

- ❑ George Miller advises presenters to stick to the magic number of seven.

“What about the magic number seven? What about the seven wonders of the world, the seven seas, the seven deadly sins, the seven daughters of Atlas in the Pleiades, the seven ages of man, the seven levels of hell, the seven primary colours, the seven notes of musical scale, and the seven days of the week? what about the seven point rating scale, the seven categories for absolute judgement, the seven objects in the span of attention, and the seven digits in the span of immediate memory?”

(“ The Magic Number Seven”, George Miller)

Dividing the Presentation

❑ Introduction

- It is central to a good oral presentation.
- It should grab attention quickly.
- It should reveal the topic along with the main themes.
- It should establish trust and credibility.

Tips for a good introduction:

- Keep it brief
- Use the art of questioning
- Quotations
- Relatable stories
- Dramatic statements

Contd...

❑ The Main Body

- It should consist of a minimum of four to five key points of discussion.
- There should be a smooth flow of ideas.
- It should sustain the interest of the audience with the use of connectives which we shall discuss in the upcoming lecture.



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Presentation Patterns

- It is suggested to break identified segments of the main body of the presentation and distinctly mark a beginning, middle and end.
- Sub-topics are a must-have.
- It should be arranged in a chronological manner that is relatable to the time period.
- If the presentation circles a problem, one should begin by describing the causes followed by the impact and move towards the remedy.
- For example, in order to explain the falling price of any commodity, one has to explain the surplus production, adverse climate conditions, etc.

Development of Points

- Use of **examples** is a widely used tool for developing an argument and validating a point.
- With **comparison and contrast**, one may relieve oneself from any dead end.
- Use of **statistics** to support an argument never fades in relevance. Any argument backed up by statistics is always a key factor in anchoring the interest of the audience.
- **Testimony** can also be sought from reports, and newspaper articles.
- **Definition** really puts forward the context where the argument is being situated so it should be included for gaining the involvement of the audience who would understand better once things are definite.

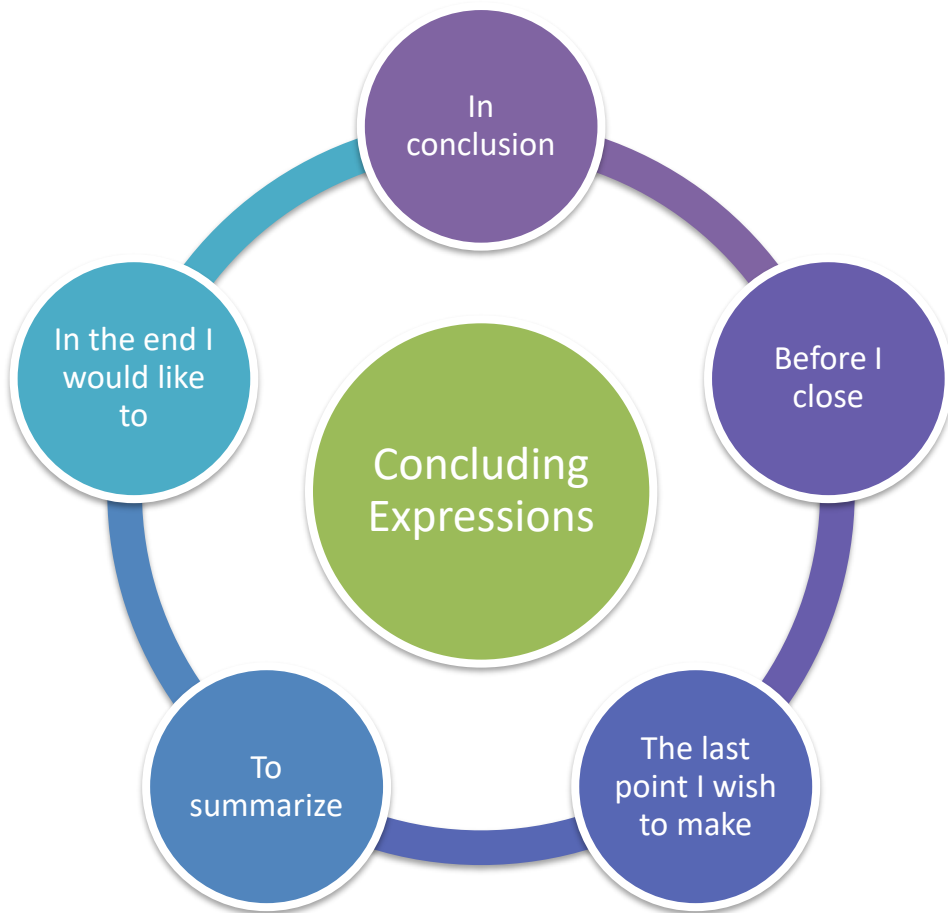
- **Conclusion**

- It holds equal importance.
- It should provide a logical inference
- It should be able to wind up all the loose ends and provide satisfaction to the audience.
- It should refrain from limp endings.

Additional Tips for Conclusion

- Do not add new information
- Only review point
- Refer to your introduction
- End with enthusiasm

(Sharma and Mishra 222)



Presentation and its relation to Audience

- The focus of the presentation is determined by the composition of the audience.
- The central idea may remain the same even if the focus of the presentation shifts dramatically corresponding to the requirement of the audience.
- One has to pay close attention to the reactions of the listeners and modify one's strategy by varying pace and volume.
- Use of attention-getters like quoting eminent persons, asking rhetorical questions, etc.



Contd...

- Inspection of the Venue
 - It should be well ventilated
 - Accessible podium
 - Screen for display
 - Availability of the required equipment
 - Availability of a technician for equipment related assistance

Work Consulted

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**“A talk is a voyage with a purpose and must be
charted. The person who starts out going nowhere
generally gets there.”
- Dale Carnegie**

Thank You